

Muhammad Yasir Khan

CONTACT INFORMATION	<i>Address:</i> 4907 Wesley W. Posvar Hall, 230 South Bouquet Street, Pittsburgh, PA 15260 <i>E-mail:</i> yasir.khan@pitt.edu <i>website:</i> www.yasirkhan.org	
EMPLOYMENT	ASSISTANT PROFESSOR Department of Economics, University of Pittsburgh	2021 -
RESEARCH AFFILIATIONS	Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab (JPAL), Center For Economic Research Pakistan (CERP), AALIMS, Center for Governance and Markets	
EDUCATION	UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA, BERKELEY - HAAS SCHOOL OF BUSINESS Ph.D in Business Administration	2015 - 2021
	COLUMBIA UNIVERSITY Masters in Public Administration	2008 - 2009
	NATIONAL UNIVERSITY OF SINGAPORE Masters in Public Policy	2007 - 2009
	LAHORE UNIVERSITY OF MANAGEMENT SCIENCES (LUMS) B.Sc. (honors) in Economics	2003 - 2007
PUBLICATIONS	“Mission Motivation and Public Sector Performance: Experimental Evidence from Pakistan”, <i>American Economic Review</i> (2025)	
	““Good Politicians”: Experimental Evidence on Motivations for Political Candidacy and Government Performance”, with Saad Gulzar, <i>The Review of Economic Studies</i> (2025)	
	“Personalities and Public Sector Performance: Experimental Evidence from Pakistan”, with Arman Rezaee, Michael Callen, Ali Hasanain, and Saad Gulzar, <i>Economic Development and Cultural Change</i> (2025)	
	“Using Preference Parameter Estimates to Optimize Public Sector Wage Contracts: A Field Study in Pakistan”, with James Andreoni, Michael Callen, Karrar Hussain and Charles Sprenger, <i>Journal of European Economic Association</i> (2023)	
	“No bulls: Experimental Evidence on the Impact of Veterinarian Ratings in Pakistan”, with Arman Rezaee, and Ali Hasanain, <i>Journal of Development Economics</i> (2023)	
	“The Political Economy of Public Employee Absence: Experimental Evidence from Pakistan”, with Michael Callen, Ali Hasanain, Saad Gulzar, and Arman Rezaee, <i>Journal of Public Economics</i> (2023)	
WORKING PAPERS	“Data and Policy Decisions: Experimental Evidence from Pakistan”, with Michael Callen, Saad Gulzar, Ali Hasanain, and Arman Rezaee, <i>Journal of Development Economics</i> (2020)	
	“Improving public health delivery in Punjab, Pakistan: issues and opportunities”, with Michael Callen, Ali Hasanain, Saad Gulzar, Abdur Rehman Khan, and Zia Mehmood <i>The Lahore Journal of Economics</i> (2013)	
	“When Credit Lines Open Fault Lines: Economic and Political Effects of Bank Lending”, with S.K. Ritadhi	
	“Norms, Beliefs, and Networks: Descriptive Findings on Women’s Political Participation in Pakistan”, with Saad Gulzar and Luke Sonnet	
	“Extreme Heat and Public Services: Evidence from Vaccinations in Pakistan”, with Karrar Hussain, Jiawei Lyu, and Gabriel Tourek	

WORK IN PROGRESS	“Mental Health and Worker Performance: Evidence from the Public Sector”, with Prashant Bhandari, Zain Chaudhry, Dietmar Fehr, and Karrar Hussain	
	“Extending State Capacity with Technology: Interactive Mobile Support to Improve Consistency and Accuracy for Community Health Workers ”, with Erika Field, Nicola Singletary, Laura Stilwell, & Kate Vyborny	
	“Time Preferences and Dishonesty in the Public Sector”, with Priyoma Mustafi	
	“Social Norms, Men’s Beliefs, and Women Voting”, with Saad Gulzar	
	“Remote Delivery of Behavioral Therapy for Perinatal Depression and Anxiety through Digital Clinics in Low-Resource Settings: A Randomized Controlled Trial”, with Zia Hydari	
MONOGRAPHS	“Barriers to Political Entry: Experimental Evidence from Pakistan”, with Saad Gulzar, <i>mimeo</i>	
	“Learning in public schools”, with Tahir Andrabi, Sohaib Khan and Farooq Naseer, <i>International Growth Centre</i>	
FELLOWSHIPS AND GRANTS	Reducing Conflict and Improving Performance in the Economy (£99,000), <i>PI</i>	2026
	Pitt Business 2030 Research Grant (\$ 12,000), <i>co-PI</i>	2025
	Center for Governance and Markets (\$14,000), <i>PI</i>	2024
	International Growth Centre (£30,397), <i>PI</i>	2024
	Pitt Momentum Funds, Priming Grant (\$24,000), <i>PI</i>	2024
	DFG, German Research Foundation Grant (Euros 330,000), <i>collaborator</i>	2023
	International Growth Centre (£20,000), <i>co-PI</i>	2022
	International Growth Centre (£44,000), <i>PI</i>	2021
	IRLE Fellowship (\$15,000), Sasakawa Fellowship (\$50,000) & Oliver Williamson Fund (\$4,000)	2020
	CEGA Development Economics (\$15,000) & Weiss Family Fund (\$15,800), <i>PI</i>	2019
	International Growth Centre (£20,000), <i>co-PI</i> & Institute for Business Innovation (\$10,000),	2018
	International Growth Centre (£15,272) & JPAL Governance Initiative (\$94,796), <i>co-PI</i>	2018
	International Growth Centre (£66,000), & JPAL Governance Initiative (\$ 73,000), <i>co-PI</i>	2015
	Agricultural Technology and Adoption Initiative (\$ 50,000), <i>co-PI</i>	2014
	International Growth Centre (£10,000), <i>co-PI</i>	2012
	International Growth Centre (£50,000), <i>co-PI</i>	2011
INVITED TALKS	Cornell University, University of Notre Dame, Georgetown University, UCLA Luskin, Oxford University, UC Irvine, UC San Diego	2025
	UIUC, University of Michigan, Public Administration Reform Global Forum st World Bank	2024
	University of Virginia	2023
	Georgetown University, Development Rookiefest at Northwestern University	2022
	University of Pittsburgh, University of California Santa Cruz, University of Oxford, Duke University, Essex, Universidad del Rosario, POLECONUK	2021
CONFERENCES	Society for Institutional and Organizational Economics	2024
	BREAD-MIT, Call to Service at Stanford, AALIMS-Stanford, PacDev (U of Washington), NEUDC, Institutions and Innovations Conference	2023
	KDI-DIME, CSAE Conference on Economic Development in Africa, MWIEDC, SIOE, ECBE, NEUDC, Field Days, PacDev (UC Berkeley), Institutions and Innovations Conference	2021
TEACHING	<i>University of Pittsburgh:</i> Graduate Development Economics (Econ 3440), Graduate Labor Economics (Econ 3410), Poverty and International Development (Econ 1710), Labor and Development Seminar (Econ 1710), Introduction to Development Economics (Econ 0530)	

	<i>UC Berkeley (as Graduate Student Instructor):</i> Economics for Business Decisions (Microeconomics), Ethics and Responsible Leadership	
ADVISING AND SERVICE	<i>Graduate Students:</i> Priyoma Mustafi, Hanrui Zeng, Bruno Komel, Prashant Bhandari, Yu Qui, Humoyun Abdumavlon, Josue Djossou, Kamran Hakiman <i>Committee:</i> Graduate Admissions Committee, Second Year Paper Award Committee <i>Mentorship:</i> Association for Mentoring & Inclusion in Economics (AMIE)	
INVITED REFEREE	Review of Economic Studies, Economic Journal, American Economic Journal: Applied, American Economic Review: Insights, Journal of Public Economics, Journal of European Economic Association, Journal of Development Economics, Management Science, Economic Development and Cultural Change, Journal of Politics, World Bank Economic Review, Quarterly Journal of Political Science, Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization, Journal of Comparative Economics, Economica, National Science Foundation	
AWARDS	“Vice Chancellor’s Alumni Achievement Award” by Lahore University of Management Sciences 2025 “50 Influential Researchers Whose Work Could Help Shape 21st Century Politicians” by Apolitical Foundation Germany 2023	
WORK EXPERIENCE	INTERNATIONAL GROWTH CENTRE (IGC)	
	Pakistan Country Economist	2011 - 2015
	AGA KHAN FOUNDATION	
	Research Officer	2010 - 2011
OTHER	Languages: English (fluent), Pashto (native), Urdu (fluent) Nationality: Pakistani	

Updated February 2, 2026